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Dubai air taxi part of public transport

DUBAI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

Ahmed Bahrozian, CEO of the Public Transport Agency at the Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) said yesterday that Dubai's upcoming air taxi service will function as a core part of the city's public transport network — not a premium or tourist-only experience.

Talking about the city's preparations with air taxi maker Joby Aviation and Skyports Infrastructure, Bahrozian said the ambition is to integrate air taxis into Dubai's everyday mobility system, eventually offering coverage comparable to a bus network.

"We are not doing a service just to take a few tourist rides or a few businesspeople from point A to point B every day. We want this service to be a very important part of mobility in the city of Dubai," he told *Gulf News* on the sidelines of Dubai Airshow.

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Dh36.7 billion fund to attract global investors launched

INVESTMENT FUND DESIGNED TO SUPERCHARGE INVESTOR GROWTH IN UAE

DUBAI
BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, has announced the establishment of the National Investment Fund with an initial capital of Dh36.7 billion, subject to increase and review.

The Vice-President made the announcement during a Cabinet meeting held at the Dubai Airshow yesterday.

Sheikh Mohammed said: "I chaired today's Cabinet meeting at the Dubai Airshow. The UAE continues to support this global platform, which brings together delegations from 115 countries and more than 150,000 specialists, reinforcing our position as a key contributor to shaping the future of the global aviation sector."

His Highness added: "As part of the Cabinet agenda, we approved the establishment of the National Investment Fund with



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■ Sheikh Mohammed speaks with Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court, during a Cabinet meeting at Dubai Airshow.

an initial capital of Dh36.7 billion, open to future review and expansion. The fund aims to encourage incoming foreign direct investment through financial incentive packages and to achieve our targets of increasing it from Dh115 billion annually to Dh240 billion by 2031, and to raise total accumulated FDI from Dh800 billion to Dh2.2 trillion. Our mes-

sage to global investors is clear. The UAE welcomes you ... The UAE will provide the world's best environment for investment ... The UAE will continue to support your growth and long-term success."

Sheikh Mohammed continued: "We reviewed progress in the National Strategy for Industry. National industrial spending

has exceeded Dh110 billion, an increase of 244 per cent over the past five years. Industrial exports reached Dh197 billion. Today, the industrial sector contributes Dh210 billion to our GDP. Our target is Dh300 billion by 2031. We will continue to support this vital sector and its rapid growth."

The Cabinet also approved the UAE National Identity Strategy.

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